

Session 27 - Battle of Tser Hill - DM Guide

Session 27 — DM Reference Guide

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Session 27 - The Battle of Tser Hill

To-Do

Introduce players to concept of "timer" 30s to roll dice and make choice. Use Big TV to Show Art/NPCs/etc.. Create Markers for units/groups, NPCs, Players, Monsters

Notes

- Players surrounded and forced to defend hill
- Create new Map based on Vistani Camp
 - Remove Tent and horses (as they scattered during the early fight)
 - Show burned buildings to West..
 - Larger stitch force coming from woods to the North quickly (within 2-3 rounds they show up on border of map)
- Work on stats for big bad Vasilka
- Brom Martikov shows up to warn them of more creatures approaching - lands and draws weapon ready to fight.
 - Have him reach out to Gregor's mind to give the warning - before eventually landing to help the defenders at the top.
- Goblin Stitches will swarm, dragging players down and tearing at them with daggers, teeth, and sharp nails. Each Goblin gives +2 to attack, and does 1d6+n*2 damage (5 goblins is +10 to attack doing 5d6+10 damage). If they get you prone - Advantage Each Goblin is +2 to STR Check DC (Start at DC10) - so Same 5 Goblins is DC20 STR check. Goblin Stiches swarms will act as single combat (1 attack per 3 Goblins).
- This Battle will likely take 2 more sessions - I don't want to rush it as this is a pivotal battle and moment in this chapter of the story.
- Show Larger Map on big TV .
- The players will realize that being swarmed is VERY bad..

NPCS

- [Vasilka](#)
- [Brom Martikov](#)
- [Emil Toranescu](#)
- [Yuri Skander](#)
- [Nikolai Wachter Jr.](#)
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Pacing

[BATTLE RESUMES]

Give players a moment reprieve to recover their footing as the baddies begin standing up and moving again. As we work through a few rounds using new SWARM Rules so they know they need to start pulling into a defensive position. As players pull back (or not) have the Goblins start swarming the players. around the base of the hill - Stiches begin to overwhelm the players - pile on Krutha/Korith - Dagger/Gregor, this should be bad.

As they stiches are attacking - Vasilka throws out more Spell Attack at hilltop defenders. Going up the hill is Difficult Terrain and requires Dex Save to move 1/2 SPEED, and fail you can move 1/4 SPEED.

Brom Martikov will try to reach out to Gregor to warn him of more of these creatures approaching from the woods to the North. After the warning, he'll swoop down and use his bow to help which ever group is most in need of it, helping them to the hill.

[REINFORCEMENTS]

As Players start up the hill or just get up, the second wave of enemies arrive. This should feel overwhelming to players give them a moment to talk about how to address this new development. This should feel like a desperate last stand for the Players, as they're forced to fall back to the Hill Top (circle the wagons) - this should feel dangerous possible TPK. Don't pull punches on players as they spread themselves out across the battlefield.

This will include a flesh golem pulling a catapult. He will lock down the arm and load up large leather bags that then get set on fire. The First shot will target an area of 20' (10' radius) | Dex Save for 1/2 8d6+8 Fire Damage. It takes 3 turns to reload and fire (1 turn to lock it down, 1 turn to load and light the ammunition, Fires on 3 turn.. Has enough shots for 4 attacks..

[WOLF PACK ARRIVES]

The Werewolves lead by Emil Toranescu joins the fray and jumps archers and outliers. Players will hear the howl of wolves, just as they burst

out of the high grass attacking the ranged goblins and casters. She'll make her way to the players on the hill.. She will tell the players about the Tser Raven Encampment and that they followed the trail here.. They'll attack the Catapult and suffer casualties while 'Emil Toranescu' pushes past the stitches to let the players know she is here to help.. They players will recognize her as the Werewolf that jumped from the Wizards tower, she has healing magic and will cast healing on any players that might need it. This will take 2-3 turns before the [END PHASE] begins.

[END PHASE]

Skanders open dimensional door to Tser Hill to send Reinforcements at the same time that Barovian Forces arrive under Ismark, Father Donavich, and Doru and 25 members of the Brovian Militia. - Players can make a Perception Check to see the DemDoor open up behind the baddies as Skands and Others tear into the rear of the baddies. - Have them see Dozens of arrows shoot out across the sky and land on top of the baddies, just as Barovian Forces come riding in hard. - Vasilka teleports to safety leaving the Stitches to their own fate as they retreat back to the Abbey...

WRAP UP

Message from van Richten they managed to take that crazy old fool and restored him with a greater restoration spell. Ezmerelda is tending to him in the back of wagon - as he is still confused about what happened but appears to be his same stubborn self.. We are heading back to town and should arrive in two days - maybe less if we take shifts on the wagon and move at night.

The Various parties will have a summit allowing the players and Key Persons to have their first strategy session against Strahd.. This starts the end phase of Curse of Strahd.

Vasilka — The Resurrected Ilya Krezkov



Medium Undead/Construct (Flesh Golem), Neutral Evil

Armor Class 16 (natural armor, enhanced by sorcery) **Hit Points** 136 (16d8 + 64) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	12 (+1)	18 (+4)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	20 (+5)

Saving Throws Con +8, Cha +9, Wis +6 **Skills** Arcana +5, Intimidation +9, Perception +6 **Damage Resistances** Cold, Fire, Lightning **Damage Immunities** Poison **Condition Immunities** Charmed, Exhaustion, Frightened, Paralyzed, Poisoned **Senses** Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 16 **Languages** Common, Abyssal **Challenge** 10 (5,900 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +4

Traits

- Flesh Golem Resilience.** Vasilka has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects. If she is subjected to an effect that allows a Constitution saving throw to take half damage, she takes no damage on a success and half damage on a failure.
- Innate Sorcery (Recharge on Short/Long Rest).** As a bonus action, Vasilka can tap into the divine spark left by the Abbot's creation. For 1 minute, her spell save DC increases by 1 (to DC 18) and she gains advantage on attack rolls for sorcerer spells she casts.
- Immutable Form.** Vasilka is immune to any spell or effect that would alter her form.
- Sorcerous Recovery (1/Day).** When Vasilka has no sorcery points remaining, she regains 4 sorcery points at the start of her next turn.

Spellcasting

- Vasilka is an 8th-level spellcaster. Her spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 17, +9 to hit with spell attacks). She has the following sorcerer spells prepared:
- Sorcery Points:** 8 **Metamagic:** Twinned Spell, Subtle Spell, Quicken Spell
- Cantrips (at will):** - *Chill Touch* — Ranged spell attack, 120 ft., 2d8 necrotic damage. Target can't regain HP until start of Vasilka's next turn. Advantage if target is undead. - *Mind Sliver* — 60 ft. INT save or 2d6 psychic damage and subtract 1d4 from target's next saving throw before end of Vasilka's next turn. - *Mage Hand* — Spectral hand appears, can manipulate objects up to 30 ft. away. - *Minor Illusion* — Create a sound or image within 30 ft. Lasts 1 minute. Investigation check vs DC 17 to see through. - *Prestidigitation* — Minor magical trick (light, clean, flavor, small illusion). Lasts 1 hour.
- 1st Level (4 slots):** - *Shield* — Reaction. +5 AC until start of next turn, including against triggering attack. Blocks Magic Missile. - *Mage Armor* (pre-cast) — AC becomes 13 + DEX. Lasts 8 hours. No concentration. - *Ray of Sickness* — Ranged spell attack, 60 ft. 2d8 poison damage. On hit, target makes CON save or is poisoned until end of its next turn.
- 2nd Level (3 slots):** - *Hold Person* — 60 ft. Target humanoid makes WIS save or is paralyzed. Repeat save at end of each turn. Melee attacks within 5 ft. auto-crit. Concentration. - *Misty Step* — Bonus action. Teleport up to 30 ft. to a space you can see. - *Shatter* — 60 ft. range, 10 ft. radius. 3d8 thunder damage. CON save for half. Disadvantage for inorganic creatures.
- 3rd Level (3 slots):** - *Counterspell* — Reaction, 60 ft. Automatically counter a spell of 3rd level or lower. For higher: CHA check DC 10 + spell level. - *Fireball* — 150 ft. range, 20 ft. radius. 8d6 fire damage. DEX save for half. Ignites flammable objects. - *Dispel Magic* — 120 ft. End one spell of 3rd level or lower on a target. Higher: CHA check DC 10 + spell level.
- 4th Level (2 slots):** - *Banishment* — 60 ft. CHA save or target is banished to a harmless demiplane for up to 1 minute. Concentration. If target is native to the current plane, it returns when the spell ends. - *Vitriolic Sphere* — 150 ft. range, 20 ft. radius. 10d4 acid damage, DEX save for half. On failed save, target also takes 5d4 acid at end of its next turn.

Unique Abilities

- Spell Redirect (Recharge 5-6).** When Vasilka sees a creature within 60 feet of her cast a spell that targets an area or makes a ranged spell attack, she can use her reaction to seize control of the spell's energy. She makes a Charisma check contested by the caster's spellcasting ability check. On a success, she redirects the spell to a new target or area of her choice within the spell's range (measured from her position). The spell uses the original caster's spell save DC and attack bonus.
- DM Note:** This is how she took control of Thorian's water spell and hurled it back over the hilltop defenders. Use this sparingly for dramatic moments.
- Command Stitches (Bonus Action).** Vasilka directs up to two Goblin Stitch Swarms within 60 feet. Each directed swarm can immediately move up to half its speed or make one attack. This does not use the swarm's reaction.

Actions

Multiattack. Vasilka makes two Necrotic Slam attacks, or she makes one Necrotic Slam attack and casts a cantrip.

Necrotic Slam. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (2d6 + 4) bludgeoning damage plus 9 (2d8) necrotic damage.

Quickened Spell (3 Sorcery Points). As a bonus action, Vasilka casts a spell that normally has a casting time of 1 action.

Reactions

Shield (1st-Level Slot). When hit by an attack or targeted by *magic missile*, Vasilka gains +5 AC until the start of her next turn, including against the triggering attack.

Counterspell (3rd-Level Slot). When a creature within 60 feet casts a spell, Vasilka attempts to interrupt it. The spell fails if it is 3rd level or lower. For higher level spells, she makes a Charisma ability check (DC 10 + spell level).

Lair Actions (Spell-Enhanced)

When fighting within 120 feet of her Goblin Stitch forces, Vasilka can use one of the following lair actions on initiative count 20 (losing ties). She cannot use the same lair action two rounds in a row.

Necrotic Surge. Dark energy pulses outward from Vasilka in a 30-foot radius. Each creature of her choice in the area must make a DC 17 Constitution saving throw, taking 14 (4d6) necrotic damage on a failure, or half on a success. Goblin Stitches in the area regain 5 hit points each.

Stitch Frenzy. Up to three Goblin Stitch Swarms within 60 feet of Vasilka are driven into a frenzy until initiative count 20 of the next round. Frenzied swarms have advantage on attack rolls and their attacks deal an extra 3 (1d6) damage, but attacks against them also have advantage.

Unnatural Fog. Vasilka summons a 20-foot-radius sphere of thick, dark fog centered on a point within 90 feet. The area is heavily obscured. The fog lasts until initiative count 20 of the next round or until dispersed by a strong wind. Vasilka and her stitches can see through this fog.

Grasp of the Dead. Spectral hands erupt from the ground in a 15-foot square within 60 feet. Each creature in the area must succeed on a DC 17 Strength saving throw or be restrained until initiative count 20 of the next round. A restrained creature can use its action to make a DC 17 Strength (Athletics) check to free itself.

Tactics

Opening Round. Vasilka stays at range (60-120 ft. from the hilltop) and opens with Fireball or Vitriolic Sphere targeting clustered defenders. She uses Subtle Spell to prevent Counterspell.

Mid-Battle. She uses Command Stitches to direct swarms toward isolated or prone targets. She saves Spell Redirect for high-impact spells from the party's casters. She uses Quickened Spell to cast Fireball or Hold Person as a bonus action while making Necrotic Slam attacks if anyone closes distance.

When Pressed. If forced into melee, she uses Misty Step to reposition and Shield to deflect attacks. She reserves Banishment for the party's strongest melee fighter.

Lair Actions. She uses Necrotic Surge to heal her swarms and damage clustered defenders. Stitch Frenzy when swarms are engaged with the party. Unnatural Fog to cover flanking movements or block line of sight to her. Grasp of the Dead to pin down melee fighters trying to reach her.

Retreat. When Vasilka drops below 40 HP, the Abbot arrives to extract her. She uses Misty Step and Counterspell defensively to survive until he reaches her, then she teleports to safety (as noted in Session 27).

DM Notes

- Vasilka is not a standard flesh golem. The Abbot used divine power and the Holy Symbol of Ravenkind to restore her, granting her sorcerous abilities far beyond what a construct should have.
- She was created using the body and essence of Ilya Krezkov. Baron Dmitri Krezkov does not know this. If he ever sees Vasilka, he would recognize his daughter's face.
- She can potentially be recruited as an ally if the players kill the Abbot without harming her or the mongrelfolk. She would want freedom for herself and her kind in exchange for their aid.
- The Abbot will arrive in person when she starts taking serious damage. He is a deva and far more dangerous than Vasilka herself.
- Her Spell Redirect is the signature "oh no" ability. When Thorian cast his water spell, she seized it and turned it against the defenders. Save this for a dramatic moment each encounter.

The Abbot's Stitches — Monster Stat Blocks

Mongrelfolk (Melee)

Small Monstrosity, Chaotic Neutral

Armor Class 11 (scraps of leather and stitched hide) **Hit Points** 22 (5d6 + 5) **Speed** 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	12 (+1)	12 (+1)	8 (-1)	10 (+0)	6 (-2)

Skills Stealth +3 **Senses** Darkvision 30 ft., Passive Perception 10 **Languages** understands Common but can barely speak it **Challenge** 1/4 (50 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Traits

Pack Mentality. The mongrelfolk has advantage on attack rolls against a creature if at least one of its allies is within 5 feet of the target and the ally isn't incapacitated.

Stitched Together. The mongrelfolk has advantage on saving throws against being frightened. It fights until destroyed, never making morale checks.

Actions

Shortsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 + 1) slashing damage.

Bite. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d4 + 1) piercing damage.

Mongrelfolk (Ranged)

Small Monstrosity, Chaotic Neutral

Armor Class 12 (patchwork leather) **Hit Points** 18 (4d6 + 4) **Speed** 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	8 (-1)	10 (+0)	6 (-2)

Skills Stealth +4 **Senses** Darkvision 30 ft., Passive Perception 10 **Languages** understands Common but can barely speak it **Challenge** 1/4 (50 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Traits

Pack Mentality. The mongrelfolk has advantage on attack rolls against a creature if at least one of its allies is within 5 feet of the target and the ally isn't incapacitated.

Stitched Together. The mongrelfolk has advantage on saving throws against being frightened. It fights until destroyed, never making morale checks.

Actions

Shortbow. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 80/320 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage.

Dagger. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) piercing damage.

Patchwork Goblin Swarm

Large Swarm of Small Monstrosities, Chaotic Evil

A writhing mass of small, stitched-together goblins that move as one. They claw, bite, stab, and drag targets to the ground under sheer weight of numbers.

Armor Class 12 (natural armor, overlapping bodies) **Hit Points** 65 (10d10 + 10) **Speed** 30 ft., climb 15 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	5 (-3)	8 (-1)	3 (-4)

Damage Resistances Bludgeoning, Piercing, Slashing **Condition Immunities** Charmed, Frightened, Grappled, Paralyzed, Petrified, Prone, Restrained, Stunned **Senses** Darkvision 30 ft., Passive Perception 9 **Languages** none **Challenge** 4 (1,100 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Traits

Swarm. The swarm can occupy another creature’s space and vice versa. The swarm can move through any opening large enough for a Small creature. The swarm can’t regain hit points or gain temporary hit points.

Overwhelming Numbers. The swarm has advantage on attack rolls against any creature that is prone.

Actions (Custom Swarm Rules)

The swarm makes **one attack per turn**, scaling with the number of goblins currently in the swarm.

Rend (Daggers, Teeth, and Claws). *Melee Weapon Attack: +2 per goblin* to hit, reach 0 ft., one target in the swarm’s space. *Hit: 1d6+1 per goblin* slashing damage.

Drag Down. The swarm attempts to drag a creature in its space to the ground. The target must succeed on a Strength saving throw or be knocked prone and restrained until the start of the swarm’s next turn. **DC = 10 + (2 x number of goblins).** A restrained creature can use its action to make a Strength (Athletics) check against the same DC to free itself.

Scaling Quick Reference

Goblins	Attack Bonus	Damage	Drag Down DC
2	+4	2d6+2	DC 14
3	+6	3d6+3	DC 16
4	+8	4d6+4	DC 18
5	+10	5d6+5	DC 20
6	+12	6d6+6	DC 22
7	+14	7d6+7	DC 24

Reactions

Pile On. When a creature in the swarm’s space is knocked prone by any source, the swarm can immediately make one Rend attack against that creature.

Swarm Tactics — DM Reference

- **One attack per swarm per turn.** The whole pile acts as a single unit.
- **+2 to attack per goblin.** Five goblins = +10 to hit.
- **1d6+1 damage per goblin.** Five goblins = 5d6+5 damage.
- **Drag Down DC = 10 + (2 x goblins).** Five goblins = DC 20 STR save.
- **Prone = advantage.** Once a target is prone, the swarm has advantage on Rend. Prone + restrained is catastrophic.
- **Commandable:** Vasilka can use Command Stitches (bonus action) to direct swarms to move half speed or make one attack.
- **Healable:** Vasilka’s Necrotic Surge lair action restores 5 HP to each swarm in range.

How to Run Swarms

1. Move the swarm into the target’s space.
2. Rend to deal damage. Track goblin count as they take losses.
3. Use Drag Down to pin melee fighters. Once prone + restrained, other swarms pile on.
4. Multiple swarms on one target is intentional. Let players feel the weight of being swarmed.
5. Players should realize quickly: “being swarmed is VERY bad.”

Flesh Golem Catapult Crew — Stat Blocks

Flesh Golem, Huge

Huge Construct, Unaligned

A massive, lumbering thing stitched together from dozens of corpses. Bigger than a standard flesh golem by half again, built for brute labor. It pulls the catapult into position and operates the mechanism with mechanical precision.

Armor Class 12 (natural armor) **Hit Points** 175 (14d12 + 84) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
24 (+7)	8 (-1)	22 (+6)	4 (-3)	8 (-1)	3 (-4)

Damage Immunities Lightning, Poison; Bludgeoning, Piercing, and Slashing from nonmagical attacks **Condition Immunities** Charmed, Exhaustion, Frightened, Paralyzed, Petrified, Poisoned **Senses** Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 9 **Languages** understands commands from the Abbot's creations but can't speak **Challenge** 8 (3,900 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Traits

- Immutable Form.** The golem is immune to any spell or effect that would alter its form.
- Lightning Absorption.** Whenever the golem is subjected to lightning damage, it takes no damage and instead regains hit points equal to the lightning damage dealt.
- Magic Resistance.** The golem has advantage on saving throws against spells and other magical effects.
- Siege Monster.** The golem deals double damage to objects and structures.
- Catapult Operator.** The golem can operate the catapult alone, performing all steps of the reload cycle without assistance.

Actions

- Multiattack.** The golem makes two Slam attacks.
- Slam.** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +10 to hit, reach 10 ft., one target. *Hit:* 20 (3d8 + 7) bludgeoning damage.
- Hurl (Recharge 5-6).** The golem grabs a creature or object within reach and hurls it up to 30 feet. If the target is a creature, it must succeed on a DC 18 Strength saving throw or be thrown, taking 14 (2d6 + 7) bludgeoning damage and landing prone. If thrown into another creature, that creature must succeed on a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw or take 10 (2d6 + 3) bludgeoning damage and be knocked prone.

Reactions

- Berserk Fury (1/Day).** When the golem drops below 60 hit points, it enters a berserk fury at the start of its next turn. While berserk, the golem has advantage on all melee attack rolls but attack rolls against it also have advantage. It attacks the nearest creature each turn. The fury lasts until the golem is destroyed or has no creatures within reach.

Catapult (Siege Weapon)

Huge Object

A crude but effective siege weapon pulled into position by the Huge Flesh Golem. It launches large leather bags stuffed with pitch-soaked rags that are set ablaze before firing.

Armor Class 15 (reinforced wood and iron) **Hit Points** 100 **Damage Immunities** Poison, Psychic **Speed** 0 ft. (must be pulled by the Flesh Golem; 30 ft. while being pulled)

Operation

The catapult requires a **3-turn reload cycle** to fire. The Flesh Golem performs all steps.

Turn	Action	Description
1	Lock Down	The golem cranks the arm into firing position and locks the mechanism.
2	Load and Light	The golem loads a leather bag of pitch-soaked materials and sets it ablaze.
3	Fire	The catapult launches the flaming payload.

Ammunition: 4 shots total.

Attack

Flaming Payload. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* automatic (targets an area, no attack roll), range 150/600 ft. The payload hits a point the operator can see and explodes on impact.

Each creature within a **10-foot radius** (20-foot diameter) of the impact point must make a **DC 15 Dexterity saving throw**, taking **8d6 + 8 fire damage** on a failure, or **half damage** on a success.

The area of impact is lightly obscured by smoke and burning debris until the end of the golem's next turn. A creature that starts its turn in the area takes 3 (1d6) fire damage.

Destroying the Catapult

- The catapult can be attacked directly (AC 15, 100 HP).
- It is immune to poison and psychic damage.
- If the catapult is destroyed while loaded and lit (Turn 2 of the cycle), it explodes. Each creature within 15 feet must make a DC 13 Dexterity saving throw, taking 4d6 fire damage on a failure, or half on a success.
- If the Flesh Golem is killed or driven off, the catapult is inoperable.

DM Notes

- The catapult arrives with the **Reinforcements** wave. Players should hear it before they see it: the creaking of wood, the thud of the golem's footsteps, and then a flaming payload arcing through the sky.
- First shot targets the densest cluster of defenders on the hilltop. Give them a round to see it being loaded and lit before it fires.
- The werewolves led by Emil Toranescu will specifically target the catapult during the Wolf Pack Arrives phase. They will suffer casualties taking it out. This gives the players a window to see allied forces making a real sacrifice.
- If players try to destroy it themselves, reward creative approaches. Lightning spells heal the golem but do nothing to the catapult. Fire won't help against a weapon that is already on fire.
- 4 shots across the battle is 12 turns of operation (3 turns per shot). The werewolves should arrive and attack it after 1-2 shots have been fired.

Brom Martikov — Wereraven Scout



Medium Humanoid (Human, Shapechanger), Chaotic Good

Armor Class 13 (leather armor) **Hit Points** 27 (5d8 + 5) **Speed** 30 ft. (fly 50 ft. in raven or hybrid form)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	15 (+2)	12 (+1)	11 (+0)	13 (+1)	12 (+1)

Skills Perception +3, Stealth +4 **Damage Immunities** Bludgeoning, Piercing, and Slashing from nonmagical attacks not made with silvered weapons **Senses** Passive Perception 13 **Languages** Common (can mimic sounds in raven form) **Challenge** 2 (450 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Traits

- Shapechanger.** Brom can use his action to polymorph into a raven-humanoid hybrid or into a raven, or back into his human form. His statistics are the same in each form. Any equipment he is wearing or carrying isn't transformed. He reverts to human form if he dies.
- Keen Sight.** Brom has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight.
- Mimicry (Raven/Hybrid Only).** Brom can mimic simple sounds he has heard. A creature that hears the sound can tell it is an imitation with a DC 10 Wisdom (Insight) check.

Actions

- Multiattack (Human/Hybrid Only).** Brom makes two attacks: one with his shortsword and one with his shortbow, or two shortsword attacks.
- Shortsword (Human/Hybrid Only).** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage.
- Shortbow (Human/Hybrid Only).** *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 80/320 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage.
- Beak (Raven/Hybrid Only).** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 1 piercing damage in raven form, or 4 (1d4 + 2) piercing damage in hybrid form.

DM Notes

- Brom is 17 years old, brave and eager. He was wounded at the Festival of Light trying to save Stella and Karl Wachter.
- As a wereraven, he is part of the Keepers of the Feather.
- Arabelle Vanduva has feelings for him.
- In this battle, Brom will fly in raven form to warn Gregor telepathically of approaching creatures from the North, then shift to hybrid form and use his bow to support whichever group is most in need.

Emil Toranescu — Werewolf Den Leader



Medium Humanoid (Human, Shapechanger), Neutral

Armor Class 14 (natural armor in hybrid/wolf form, hide armor in human form) **Hit Points** 90 (12d8 + 36)
Speed 30 ft. (40 ft. in wolf form)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	11 (+0)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)

Skills Athletics +6, Perception +5, Survival +5, Medicine +5 **Damage Immunities** Bludgeoning, Piercing, and Slashing from nonmagical attacks not made with silvered weapons **Senses** Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 15 **Languages** Common **Challenge** 5 (1,800 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Traits

Shapechanger. Emil can use her action to polymorph into a wolf-humanoid hybrid, a dire wolf, or back into her human form. Her statistics other than AC are the same in each form. Any equipment she is wearing or carrying isn't transformed. She reverts to human form if she dies.

Keen Hearing and Smell. Emil has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on hearing or smell.

Pack Tactics. Emil has advantage on attack rolls against a creature if at least one of her allies is within 5 feet of the target and the ally isn't incapacitated.

Shaman's Gift. Emil has innate spellcasting through her connection to the primal spirits of Barovia. Her spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 13, +5 to hit).

Spellcasting

At will: - *Spare the Dying* — Touch a creature at 0 HP. It becomes stable. No action needed beyond touch.

2/day each: - *Cure Wounds* (2nd level) — Touch. Restore 2d8 + 2 hit points. Does not work on undead or constructs. - *Healing Word* — Bonus action, 60 ft. range. Restore 1d4 + 2 hit points. Can attack and heal same turn.

1/day: - *Lesser Restoration* — Touch. End one disease or one condition: blinded, deafened, paralyzed, or poisoned.

Actions

Multiattack (Hybrid Form Only). Emil makes two attacks: one with her bite and one with her claws, or two with her greatsword.

Bite (Wolf/Hybrid Only). *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (1d10 + 3) piercing damage. If the target is a humanoid, it must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or be cursed with lycanthropy.

Claws (Hybrid Only). *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 8 (2d4 + 3) slashing damage.

Greatsword (Human/Hybrid Only). *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (2d6 + 3) slashing damage.

DM Notes

- Emil leads the werewolf pack that arrives during the Wolf Pack Arrives phase.
- She does not want to continue the war with humans. She lost her mate Zuleika to Strahd's treachery.
- She has healing magic and will cast healing on injured players once she reaches the hilltop.
- Players will recognize her as the werewolf that jumped from the Wizard's Tower.
- Her wolves will attack the catapult and the ranged goblin archers, suffering casualties in the process.
- Emil pushes through the stitches to reach the players and offer her help directly.

Yuri Skander — The Prime Skander



Medium Humanoid (Human), Neutral Good

Armor Class 14 (mage armor) **Hit Points** 55 (10d8 + 10) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
9 (-1)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	18 (+4)	13 (+1)	11 (+0)

Saving Throws Int +7, Wis +4 **Skills** Arcana +7, History +7, Investigation +7 **Senses** Passive Perception 11
Languages Common, Elvish, Draconic **Challenge** 5 (1,800 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Traits

Skander Duplicates. Yuri is the Prime Skander. He and his duplicates (Iskander, etc.) share memories from before the duplication but have since diverged. They coordinate well in combat and can anticipate each other’s tactics.

Spellcasting

Yuri is a 7th-level wizard. His spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 15, +7 to hit with spell attacks).

Cantrips (at will): - *Fire Bolt* — Ranged spell attack, 120 ft., 2d10 fire damage. - *Mage Hand* — Spectral hand appears, can manipulate objects up to 30 ft. away. - *Prestidigitation* — Minor magical trick (light, clean, flavor, small illusion). Lasts 1 hour. - *Minor Illusion* — Create a sound or image of an object within 30 ft. Lasts 1 minute. Investigation check vs DC 15 to see through.

1st Level (4 slots): - *Mage Armor* (pre-cast) — AC becomes 13 + DEX. Lasts 8 hours. No concentration. - *Magic Missile* — 3 darts, each deals 1d4+1 force damage. Auto-hit. No attack roll. - *Shield* — Reaction. +5 AC until start of next turn, including against triggering attack. Blocks Magic Missile. - *Thunderwave* — 15 ft. cube originating from caster. 2d8 thunder damage, CON save for half. Failed save pushed 10 ft.

2nd Level (3 slots): - *Misty Step* — Bonus action. Teleport up to 30 ft. to a space you can see. - *Scorching Ray* — 3 rays, ranged spell attack each. 2d6 fire damage per ray. Can target same or different creatures. - *Hold Person* — 60 ft. Target humanoid must make WIS save or be paralyzed. Repeat save at end of each turn. Concentration.

3rd Level (3 slots): - *Counterspell* — Reaction, 60 ft. Automatically counter a spell of 3rd level or lower. For higher: INT check DC 10 + spell level. - *Fireball* — 150 ft. range, 20 ft. radius. 8d6 fire damage. DEX save for half. - *Dispel Magic* — 120 ft. End one spell of 3rd level or lower on a target. Higher: INT check DC 10 + spell level.

4th Level (1 slot): - *Dimension Door* — Teleport self + one willing creature to any spot within 500 ft. No line of sight needed.

Actions

Dagger. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) piercing damage.

DM Notes

- Yuri is the original Skander, from whom five duplicates were created by a magical accident involving an amulet of wishing.
- He runs Skanders Imporium of Magic in Vallaki.
- The Skanders hate Strahd after Rahadin murdered their brother Oskander.
- Yuri arrives via Dimensional Door during the End Phase, as part of the Skander reinforcements.

Iskander — Skander Duplicate Wizard



Medium Humanoid (Human), Neutral Good

Armor Class 14 (mage armor) **Hit Points** 45 (8d8 + 8) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
9 (-1)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	18 (+4)	12 (+1)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws Int +7, Wis +4 **Skills** Arcana +7, Investigation +7 **Senses** Passive Perception 11 **Languages** Common, Elvish, Draconic **Challenge** 4 (1,100 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Traits

Skander Coordination. When Iskander can see another Skander duplicate or the Prime within 30 feet, he has advantage on initiative rolls and can't be surprised.

Spellcasting

Iskander is a 6th-level wizard. His spellcasting ability is Intelligence (spell save DC 15, +7 to hit with spell attacks).

Cantrips (at will): - *Ray of Frost* — Ranged spell attack, 60 ft., 2d8 cold damage. Target's speed reduced by 10 ft. until start of next turn. - *Mage Hand* — Spectral hand appears, can manipulate objects up to 30 ft. away. - *Light* — Touch an object. It sheds bright light in 20 ft. radius, dim light 20 ft. beyond. Lasts 1 hour. - *Message* — Whisper a message to a creature within 120 ft. Target can whisper back. Others can't hear it.

1st Level (4 slots): - *Mage Armor* (pre-cast) — AC becomes 13 + DEX. Lasts 8 hours. No concentration. - *Shield* — Reaction. +5 AC until start of next turn, including against triggering attack. Blocks Magic Missile. - *Magic Missile* — 3 darts, each deals 1d4+1 force damage. Auto-hit. No attack roll. - *Detect Magic* — Sense magic within 30 ft. for 10 min. Concentration. Can see aura and determine school.

2nd Level (3 slots): - *Shatter* — 60 ft. range, 10 ft. radius. 3d8 thunder damage. CON save for half. Disadvantage for inorganic creatures. - *Web* — 60 ft. range, 20 ft. cube. Area becomes difficult terrain. Creatures starting turn in web or entering: DEX save or restrained. Concentration, 1 hour. Flammable. - *Misty Step* — Bonus action. Teleport up to 30 ft. to a space you can see.

3rd Level (3 slots): - *Counterspell* — Reaction, 60 ft. Automatically counter a spell of 3rd level or lower. For higher: INT check DC 10 + spell level. - *Lightning Bolt* — 100 ft. line, 5 ft. wide. 8d6 lightning damage. DEX save for half. Ignites flammable objects. - *Slow* — 120 ft. range, up to 6 creatures in 40 ft. cube. WIS save. On fail: halved speed, -2 AC, -2 DEX saves, no reactions, only 1 attack per turn, spells take 2 turns. Concentration, 1 min.

Actions

Quarterstaff. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d6 - 1) bludgeoning damage.

DM Notes

- Iskander is one of five duplicates of Yuri Skander, created by the accidental triggering of an amulet of wishing.
- He retains all of Yuri's original memories and abilities but has diverged into his own person.
- The Skanders hate Strahd after Rahadin murdered their brother Oskander.
- He arrives via Dimensional Door during the End Phase with the Skander reinforcements.

Nikolai Wachter Jr. — Noble Fighter



Medium Humanoid (Human), Neutral Good

Armor Class 16 (chain mail) **Hit Points** 52 (8d8 + 16) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	11 (+0)	10 (+0)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws Str +5, Con +4 **Skills** Athletics +5, Persuasion +4, Intimidation +4 **Senses** Passive Perception 10
Languages Common **Challenge** 3 (700 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Traits

- Brave.** Nikolai has advantage on saving throws against being frightened.
- Wine-Fueled Resilience.** Nikolai has advantage on Constitution saving throws against poison.

Actions

- Multiattack.** Nikolai makes two longsword attacks.
- Longsword.** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) slashing damage, or 8 (1d10 + 3) slashing damage if used with two hands.
- Shield Bash.** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d4 + 3) bludgeoning damage. If the target is Medium or smaller, it must succeed on a DC 13 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone.

Reactions

- Parry.** Nikolai adds 2 to his AC against one melee attack that would hit him. He must see the attacker and be wielding a melee weapon.

DM Notes

- Nikolai Jr. is Lady Fiona Wachter's eldest son and heir to Wachterhaus.
- He is fond of wine and trouble but is a capable fighter when it counts.
- He commands the Wachter militia forces.
- At the Festival of Light, he protected Elvir Martikov (Urwin's youngest daughter). The two have feelings for each other.
- He arrives with the End Phase reinforcements.

Doru — Militia Commander



Medium Humanoid (Human), Lawful Good

Armor Class 16 (chain mail) **Hit Points** 58 (9d8 + 18) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
16 (+3)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws Str +6, Con +5 **Skills** Athletics +6, Intimidation +5, Perception +4 **Senses** Darkvision 30 ft., Passive Perception 14 **Languages** Common **Challenge** 4 (1,100 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Traits

- Survivor of the Undercroft.** Doru spent months as a vampire spawn chained in a church undercroft. He has advantage on saving throws against being frightened and against effects from undead creatures.
- Militia Commander.** Doru can use a bonus action to direct one allied militia member within 30 feet to make a weapon attack as a reaction.
- Lingering Darkness.** Doru retains darkvision from his time as a vampire spawn.

Actions

- Multiattack.** Doru makes two longsword attacks.
- Longsword.** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) slashing damage, or 8 (1d10 + 3) slashing damage if used with two hands.
- Javelin.** *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 30/120 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage.
- Rally (Recharge 5-6).** Doru shouts a rallying cry. Each allied creature within 30 feet that can hear him gains 8 (1d8 + 4) temporary hit points.

DM Notes

- Doru was a vampire spawn, cured when the party killed Seraphine Stormraven at the Battle of Tser Pool.
- He reformed the Village Militia alongside his old friend Ismark.
- He and Father Donavich serve as the militia's command structure: Doru as commander, Donavich as healer.
- He arrives with the Barovian Forces during the End Phase with Ismark, Donavich, and 25 militia members.

Father Donavich — Militia Healer



Medium Humanoid (Human), Lawful Good

Armor Class 14 (chain shirt) **Hit Points** 38 (7d8 + 7) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (+0)	10 (+0)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	17 (+3)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws Wis +6, Cha +5 **Skills** Medicine +6, Religion +4, Insight +6 **Senses** Passive Perception 13
Languages Common **Challenge** 3 (700 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Traits

Renewed Faith. Donavich’s faith was shattered and restored. He has advantage on saving throws against being charmed or frightened by undead.

Spellcasting

Donavich is a 5th-level cleric. His spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 14, +6 to hit with spell attacks).

Cantrips (at will): - *Sacred Flame* — 60 ft. DEX save or 2d8 radiant damage. Ignores cover. No attack roll. - *Spare the Dying* — Touch a creature at 0 HP. It becomes stable. - *Guidance* — Touch. Target adds 1d4 to one ability check within 1 minute. Concentration.

1st Level (4 slots): - *Cure Wounds* — Touch. Restore 1d8 + 3 hit points. - *Healing Word* — Bonus action, 60 ft. Restore 1d4 + 3 hit points. Can attack and heal same turn. - *Bless* — 30 ft. Up to 3 creatures add 1d4 to attack rolls and saving throws. Concentration, 1 min. - *Shield of Faith* — 60 ft. +2 AC to one creature. Concentration, 10 min.

2nd Level (3 slots): - *Aid* — 30 ft. Up to 3 creatures gain +5 to max HP and current HP. Lasts 8 hours. No concentration. - *Prayer of Healing* (out of combat) — Up to 6 creatures within 30 ft. each regain 2d8 + 3 HP. 10 minute casting time. - *Spiritual Weapon* — Bonus action, 60 ft. Summon spectral weapon. Bonus action each turn to attack: +6 to hit, 1d8 + 3 force. Lasts 1 min. No concentration.

3rd Level (2 slots): - *Mass Healing Word* — Bonus action, 60 ft. Up to 6 creatures each regain 1d4 + 3 HP. - *Spirit Guardians* — 15 ft. radius around Donavich. Hostile creatures entering or starting turn: WIS save, 3d8 radiant on fail, half on success. Speed halved in area. Concentration, 10 min.

Actions

Mace. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 3 (1d6) bludgeoning damage.

DM Notes

- Donavich's faith was shattered when his son Doru was turned into a vampire spawn, then restored when the party killed Seraphine.
- He serves as second in command and healer of the reformed Village Militia.
- He blessed the militia before marching and serves as their spiritual backbone.
- He arrives with the Barovian Forces during the End Phase.
- His priority is keeping the militia alive with healing. He will not be on the front line.

Ismark Kolyanovich — Militia Leader



Medium Humanoid (Human), Lawful Good

Armor Class 17 (half plate, shield) **Hit Points** 75 (10d8 + 30) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
17 (+3)	12 (+1)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	15 (+2)

Saving Throws Str +6, Con +6 **Skills** Athletics +6, Perception +5, Persuasion +5, History +4 **Senses** Passive Perception 15 **Languages** Common **Challenge** 5 (1,800 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Traits

Survivor of Castle Ravenloft. Ismark survived the assault on Castle Ravenloft. He has advantage on saving throws against being frightened.

Inspiring Leader. At the start of combat, Ismark can give a brief rallying speech. Up to 6 allies who can hear him within 30 feet gain 8 temporary hit points. This can be used once per short rest.

Protector. When a creature Ismark can see attacks a target within 5 feet of him, he can use his reaction to impose disadvantage on the attack roll. He must be wielding a shield.

Actions

Multiattack. Ismark makes two longsword attacks.

Longsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) slashing damage, or 8 (1d10 + 3) slashing damage if used with two hands.

Handaxe. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) slashing damage.

Reactions

Parry. Ismark adds 2 to his AC against one melee attack that would hit him. He must see the attacker and be wielding a melee weapon.

DM Notes

- Ismark was once called “Ismark the Lesser,” but has proven himself a capable leader.
- He leads the reformed Village Militia, the Barovian contingent, alongside Doru. Nearly 75 men under arms.
- He arrives riding hard with the Barovian Forces during the End Phase, with Donavich, Doru, and 25 militia members.
- He is Ireena’s brother (adopted). He is fiercely protective of her.
- A veteran of the failed assault on Castle Ravenloft alongside Mordenkainen.

Ireena Kolyana — Noble Fighter



Medium Humanoid (Human), Lawful Good

Armor Class 16 (chain mail) **Hit Points** 52 (8d8 + 16) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws Dex +4, Cha +5 **Skills** Athletics +4, Insight +3, Persuasion +5, Perception +3 **Senses** Passive Perception 13 **Languages** Common **Challenge** 3 (700 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Traits

Reincarnation of Tatyana. Ireena is the latest reincarnation of Tatyana. She has advantage on saving throws against charm effects from Strahd or his servants.

Defiant Spirit. When Ireena is reduced to half her hit points or fewer, she gains advantage on attack rolls until the end of her next turn.

Actions

Multiattack. Ireena makes two rapier attacks.

Rapier. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) piercing damage.

Light Crossbow. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 80/320 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) piercing damage.

Reactions

Parry. Ireena adds 2 to her AC against one melee attack that would hit her. She must see the attacker and be wielding a melee weapon.

DM Notes

- Ireena is the adopted daughter of the late Burgomaster Kolyan Indirovich and sister of Ismark.
- She is the reincarnation of Tatyana. Strahd has bitten her twice. She keeps the marks covered with a scarf.
- She is skilled with a sword and refuses to be a helpless victim.
- Izek Strazni is her biological brother, though neither knows the truth.
- She is brave, compassionate, and determined.

Baron Vargas Vallakovich — Noble Commander



Medium Humanoid (Human), Lawful Neutral

Armor Class 15 (breastplate) **Hit Points** 39 (6d8 + 12) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws Wis +3, Cha +5 **Skills** Insight +3, Persuasion +5, History +4, Intimidation +5 **Senses** Passive Perception 11 **Languages** Common **Challenge** 2 (450 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Traits

All Will Be Well. Once per short rest, Baron Vallakovich can inspire his allies. Up to 3 creatures within 30 feet that can hear him gain advantage on their next saving throw within 1 minute.

Political Authority. The Baron has advantage on Charisma (Persuasion) and Charisma (Intimidation) checks when dealing with Barovian citizens.

Actions

Longsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d8 + 1) slashing damage.

Command (1/Day). The Baron issues a single-word command to a creature within 60 feet that can hear and understand him. The target must succeed on a DC 13 Wisdom saving throw or follow the command on its next turn.

DM Notes

- Baron Vallakovich is the burgomaster of Vallaki. He genuinely wants the best for his people.
- He is not a strong combatant but provides morale and political authority.
- He is close friends with Baron Krezkov and the other burgomasters.
- His trusted protector is Izek Strazni, who handles the fighting.
- “All will be well!” is his motto. He clings to hope even in Barovia’s darkness.

Baron Dmitri Krezkov — Noble Warrior



Medium Humanoid (Human), Lawful Good

Armor Class 16 (chain mail) **Hit Points** 52 (8d8 + 16) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	11 (+0)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)

Saving Throws Str +4, Con +4 **Skills** Athletics +4, Insight +4, Intimidation +4, Perception +4 **Senses** Passive Perception 14 **Languages** Common **Challenge** 3 (700 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Traits

Guardian of Krezk. Dmitri has advantage on attack rolls against creatures that have damaged one of his allies within the last round.

Stern Resolve. Dmitri has advantage on saving throws against being charmed or frightened.

Actions

Multiattack. Dmitri makes two warhammer attacks.

Warhammer. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) bludgeoning damage, or 7 (1d10 + 2) bludgeoning damage if used with two hands.

Shield Bash. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) bludgeoning damage. The target must succeed on a DC 12 Strength saving throw or be knocked prone.

Reactions

Protective Strike. When a creature within 5 feet of Dmitri hits an ally with a melee attack, Dmitri can make one warhammer attack against that creature.

DM Notes

- Dmitri is the burgomaster of Krezk, a cautious and protective leader.
- His wife Anna is a sorceress and his steady anchor.
- His daughter Ilya was used by the Abbot to create Vasilka. Dmitri does not know this.
- If Dmitri ever sees Vasilka, he would recognize his daughter's face. This could be a pivotal story moment during this battle.
- He is close friends with Baron Vallakovich and the late Kolyan Indirovich.

Izek Strazni — Captain of the Guard



Medium Humanoid (Human, Mutated), Neutral

Armor Class 16 (chain mail) **Hit Points** 85 (10d8 + 40) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
18 (+4)	12 (+1)	18 (+4)	10 (+0)	10 (+0)	8 (-1)

Saving Throws Str +7, Con +7 **Skills** Athletics +7, Intimidation +2, Perception +3 **Damage Resistances** Fire
Senses Passive Perception 13 **Languages** Common **Challenge** 5 (1,800 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Traits

- Fiendish Arm.** Izek’s monstrous, oversized arm is wreathed in barbs and can conjure fire. He has resistance to fire damage and his melee attacks with the arm deal extra fire damage.
- Brute.** A melee weapon deals one extra die of its damage when Izek hits with it (included in attacks).
- Fearsome Presence.** Creatures that can see Izek’s monstrous arm have disadvantage on Charisma (Persuasion) checks against him.

Actions

- Multiattack.** Izek makes two attacks: one with his battleaxe and one with his fiendish arm, or he uses Hurl Flame twice.
- Battleaxe.** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 13 (2d8 + 4) slashing damage, or 15 (2d10 + 4) slashing damage if used with two hands.
- Fiendish Arm.** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 11 (2d6 + 4) bludgeoning damage plus 3 (1d6) fire damage. On a hit, Izek can grapple the target (escape DC 15).
- Hurl Flame.** *Ranged Spell Attack:* +7 to hit (uses STR), range 60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (3d6) fire damage. If the target is a flammable object not being worn or carried, it also catches fire.

DM Notes

- Izek is Ireena’s biological brother, separated in childhood during a dire wolf attack. Neither knows the truth.
- His monstrous arm grew back through unknown means, possibly a dark gift or fiendish pact.
- He is obsessed with Ireena’s face, which he sees in dreams. He commissions Blinsky to make dolls in her likeness.
- Fiercely loyal to Baron Vallakovich. He protects the Baron and handles the fighting.
- Volatile temper. Can be dangerously unpredictable when provoked.

Urwin Martikov — Wereraven Innkeeper



Medium Humanoid (Human, Shapechanger), Lawful Good

Armor Class 13 (leather armor) **Hit Points** 44 (8d8 + 8) **Speed** 30 ft. (fly 50 ft. in raven or hybrid form)

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	15 (+2)	12 (+1)	13 (+1)	15 (+2)	14 (+2)

Skills Perception +4, Stealth +4, Insight +4, Nature +3 **Damage Immunities** Bludgeoning, Piercing, and Slashing from nonmagical attacks not made with silvered weapons **Senses** Passive Perception 14 **Languages** Common (can mimic sounds in raven form) **Challenge** 3 (700 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +2

Traits

Shapechanger. Urwin can use his action to polymorph into a raven-humanoid hybrid or into a raven, or back into his human form. His statistics are the same in each form. Any equipment he is wearing or carrying isn't transformed. He reverts to human form if he dies.

Keen Sight. Urwin has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight.

Keeper of the Feather. Urwin is a senior member of the Keepers of the Feather spy network. He has advantage on Wisdom (Insight) checks and Intelligence (Investigation) checks when gathering information.

Spellcasting (Innate)

Urwin has limited innate spellcasting from his wereraven lineage. His spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 12, +4 to hit).

At will: - *Message* — Whisper a message to a creature within 120 ft. Target can whisper back. Others can't hear it.

2/day each: - *Faerie Fire* — 60 ft. range, 20 ft. cube. DEX save or outlined in light. Attacks against outlined creatures have advantage. Invisible creatures become visible. Concentration, 1 min. - *Cure Wounds* (1st level) — Touch. Restore 1d8 + 2 hit points.

Actions

Multiattack (Human/Hybrid Only). Urwin makes two attacks: one with his shortsword and one with his hand crossbow, or two shortsword attacks.

Shortsword (Human/Hybrid Only). *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage.

Hand Crossbow (Human/Hybrid Only). *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 30/120 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) piercing damage.

Beak (Raven/Hybrid Only). *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 1 piercing damage in raven form, or 4 (1d4 + 2) piercing damage in hybrid form.

DM Notes

- Urwin runs the Blue Water Inn in Vallaki with his wife Danika. Both are wereravens.
- He is Davian Martikov's son and a senior member of the Keepers of the Feather.
- The Blue Water Inn is the intelligence hub for the wereraven spy network.
- His children are Elvir, Brom (17), and Bray (14), all wereravens.
- The entire Martikov family are vowed enemies of Strahd.

Kasimir Velikov — Dusk Elf Ranger



Medium Humanoid (Elf), Neutral

Armor Class 15 (studded leather) **Hit Points** 58 (9d8 + 18) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	16 (+3)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	10 (+0)

Saving Throws Dex +6, Wis +6 **Skills** Perception +6, Stealth +6, Survival +6, Nature +5 **Senses** Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 16 **Languages** Common, Elvish **Challenge** 4 (1,100 XP) **Proficiency Bonus** +3

Traits

Fey Ancestry. Kasimir has advantage on saving throws against being charmed, and magic can't put him to sleep.

Night Watch Leader. Kasimir leads the Night Watch that patrols the Tser Hill camp perimeter. He has advantage on Wisdom (Perception) checks at night and can't be surprised while conscious.

Favored Enemy. Kasimir has advantage on Wisdom (Survival) checks to track undead and lycanthropes, and on Intelligence checks to recall information about them.

Spellcasting

Kasimir is a 5th-level ranger spellcaster. His spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC 14, +6 to hit with spell attacks).

1st Level (4 slots): - *Hunter's Mark* — Bonus action, 90 ft. Mark a creature. Deal extra 1d6 damage to it on each hit. If target drops to 0 HP, can move mark to new target as bonus action. Concentration, 1 hour. - *Cure Wounds* — Touch. Restore 1d8 + 3 hit points. - *Ensnaring Strike* — Bonus action, self. Next hit: target makes STR save or is restrained by vines. Restrained target takes 1d6 piercing at start of each turn. Concentration. - *Absorb Elements* — Reaction when taking acid, cold, fire, lightning, or thunder damage. Resistance to that damage until start of next turn. Next melee attack deals extra 1d6 of that damage type.

2nd Level (2 slots): - *Pass Without Trace* — Self, 30 ft. radius. Each creature you choose gains +10 to Stealth checks. Can't be tracked except by magical means. Concentration, 1 hour. - *Spike Growth* — 150 ft. range, 20 ft. radius. Area becomes difficult terrain. Each 5 ft. of movement through area deals 2d4 piercing damage. Camouflaged (Perception check vs DC 14 to notice). Concentration, 10 min.

Actions

Multiattack. Kasimir makes two longbow attacks or two shortsword attacks.

Longbow. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, range 150/600 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d8 + 3) piercing damage.

Shortsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +6 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d6 + 3) piercing damage.

DM Notes

- Kasimir is the leader of the dusk elves at Tser Hill. His ears were cut off by Rahadin on Strahd's orders.
- He is haunted by visions from his dead sister Patrina, who was stoned to death by her own people when she agreed to become Strahd's bride.
- He seeks the Amber Temple to resurrect Patrina, unaware her spirit has been corrupted by dark powers.
- He leads the Night Watch that patrols the Tser Hill camp perimeter.
- He knows of the power located in the ancient ruins beneath the Amber Temple.

Arrigal Vanduva — Vistani Spy



Medium Humanoid (Human), Neutral Evil

Armor Class 15 (studded leather) **Hit Points** 52 (8d8 + 16) **Speed** 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
12 (+1)	18 (+4)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)

Saving Throws Dex +7, Int +5 **Skills** Deception +6, Stealth +7, Perception +5, Insight +5, Sleight of Hand +7, Acrobatics +7 **Senses** Passive Perception 15 **Languages** Common, Vistani Cant **Challenge** 4 (1,100 XP)
Proficiency Bonus +3

Traits

Cunning Action. On each of his turns, Arrigal can use a bonus action to take the Dash, Disengage, or Hide action.

Sneak Attack (1/Turn). Arrigal deals an extra 14 (4d6) damage when he hits a target with a weapon attack and has advantage on the attack roll, or when the target is within 5 feet of an ally of Arrigal's that isn't incapacitated and Arrigal doesn't have disadvantage on the attack roll.

Evasion. When subjected to an effect that allows a Dexterity saving throw for half damage, Arrigal takes no damage on a success and half damage on a failure.

Double Agent. Arrigal secretly reports to Strahd. He will fight convincingly alongside allies but may withhold effort or “miss” key strikes at critical moments at the DM's discretion.

Actions

Multiattack. Arrigal makes two scimitar attacks.

Scimitar. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 7 (1d6 + 4) slashing damage.

Dagger. *Melee or Ranged Weapon Attack:* +7 to hit, reach 5 ft. or range 20/60 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d4 + 4) piercing damage.

Reactions

Uncanny Dodge. When an attacker Arrigal can see hits him with an attack, he can halve the attack's damage against him.

DM Notes

- Arrigal traded his loyalty to Strahd for his life years ago. He is one of Strahd's most trusted spies among the Vistani.
- His spy role is unknown to his brother Luvash, who trusts him completely.
- He delivered the false letter from the Burgomaster that lured the adventurers to Barovia.
- He will fight alongside the allies during this battle, but he is reporting everything to Strahd.
- He wants facts, timelines, who saw what. He fears misreading the next move.
- His alignment tag is “enemy” but he presents as a trusted ally. Play him as helpful, competent, and always watching.